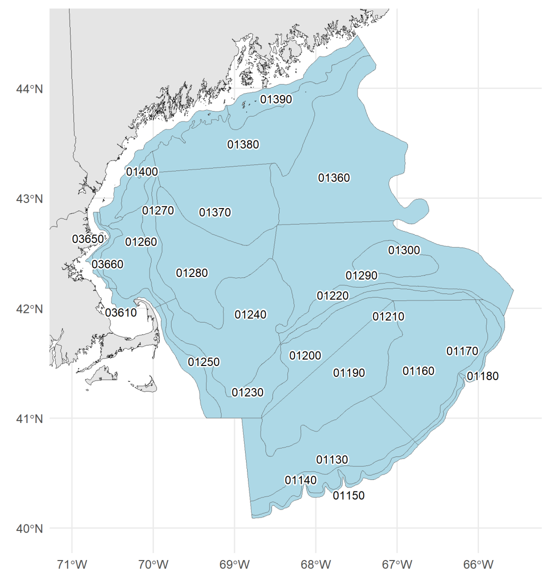
American Plaice (*Hippoglossoides platessoides*) Snapshot Ecosystem & Socioeconomic Profile

Fall 2026



2026 in Review

Fishing Community Observations

- Text here

Commercial Fishery

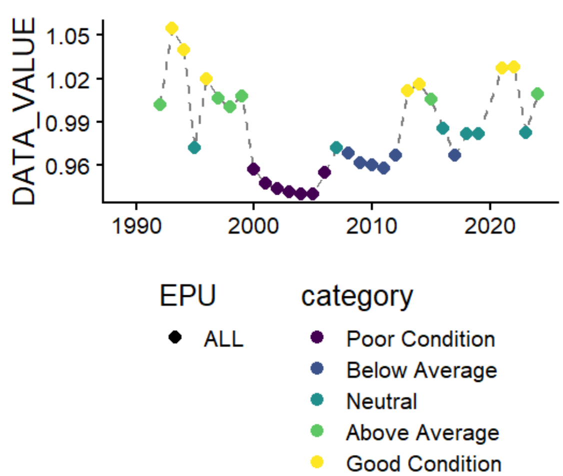
- Text here

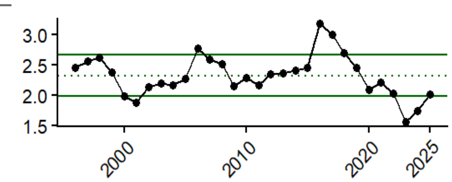
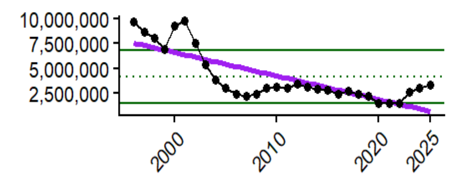
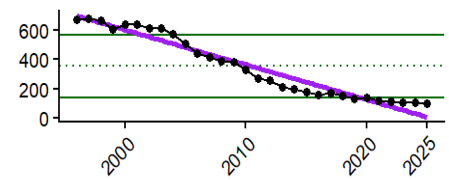
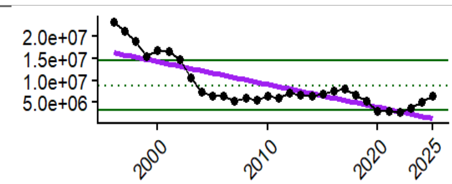
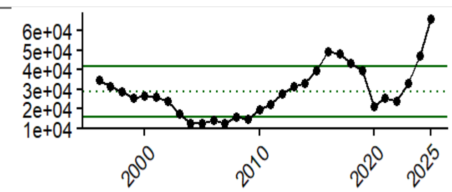
Ecosystem

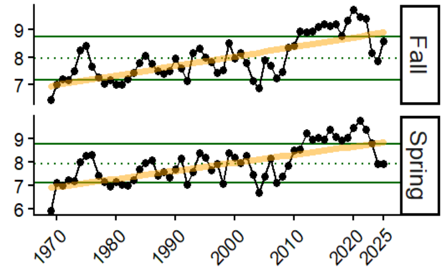
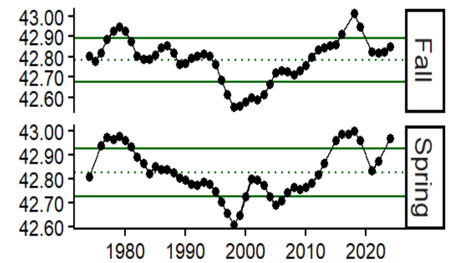
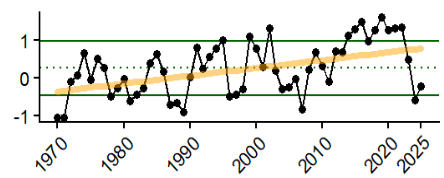
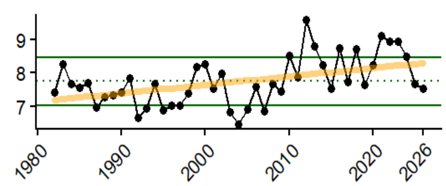
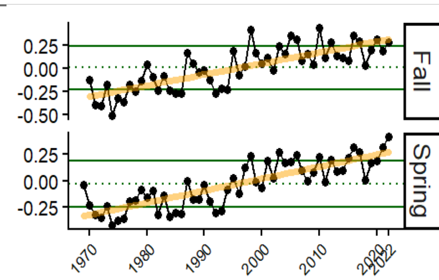
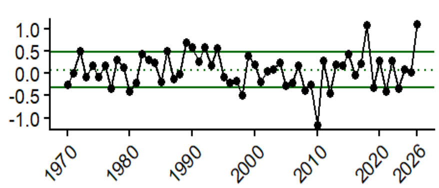
- Text here

Species Condition/Distribution Maps?/Some other title here

Condition of American plaice across the Northeast Shelf exhibited lows in the 2000s to 2010, indicating thinner, lower-quality fish. Condition values have increased overall since 2010, with most recent years having neutral to good condition, and are experiencing fewer years of poor or below-average condition compared to lows in the 2000s.



Indicator Units	Status In 2026	Implications	Time Series
Average price (2025 USD/lb)	Below the long term mean	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
Commerical landings (millions of lbs)	Near the long term mean	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
Number of commercial vessels (# of federally-permitted vessels landing over 1lb of American plaice)	Below the long term mean	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
Commercial revenue (millions, inflation adjusted to 2025 USD)	Near the long term mean	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
Commercial revenue per active American plaice vessel (2025 USD)	Above the long term mean	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	

Indicator Units	Status In 2026	Implications	Time Series
Bottom temperature (annual prior to Fall and Spring surveys, °C)	Near the long term mean (fall and spring)	Since 2023, annual mean temperatures prior to the fall survey (October - September) have declined from recent highs and are near the long-term mean. An overall warming trend in bottom temperatures may eventually result in changes in plaice distribution and condition. Annual bottom temp anomaly leading up to spring survey (March-February) is positively correlated with the mean latitude where plaice are found in the spring. Annual temperatures (Mar-Feb) were above the long-term mean in the 2010s peaking 2020. This data set does not yet include 2026.	
Center of Gravity (Latitude)	Near the long term mean (fall), above the long term mean (spring)	Add implications here (3-5 sentences)	
Gulf Stream Index (annual mean prior to Fall survey)	Near the long term mean	The annual mean of the Gulf Stream position leading up to fall survey affects recruitment. There is an overall long-term increasing trend in the position of the Gulf Stream since 1970, with the Gulf Stream being further north than the long-term mean in the 2010s, which may be contributing to warmer water temperatures in the Gulf of Maine and affecting plaice recruitment.	
Sea Surface Temperature (Mar-June)	Near the long term mean	March-June SST anomaly affects plaice recruitment. Spring temperatures have hovered around 7-8°C since the early 1980s, however temperatures in the early 2020s exceeded the long-term mean. Seasonal temperatures have declined since 2022, which may be beneficial for plaice recruitment. However, a long-term increasing trend in sea surface temperatures may lead to overall declines in recruitment.	
AMO (6 months prior to Fall and Spring survey)	Above the long term mean (fall and spring)	The AMO index has been above the long-term mean since 2020. AMO values below 0 and above 0.25 are associated with lower recruitment, while values between approximately 0-0.25 are associated with higher recruitment (Behan and Kerr 2022, fig. 2). Recent AMO values are positive, with some being above the transition point of ~0.25, so impacts on recruitment may be mixed.	
NAO (annual mean)	Above the long term mean	The NAO index has a 1-2 year lag effect on American plaice recruitment. NAO has a significant effect on depth of occurrence in the fall and mean latitude in the spring.	

Please contact nefsc.esp.leads@noaa.gov with any questions or comments.